

OpenStreetMap

A wiki-like approach to maps, this project is a Open Source approach to mapping the face of the Earth

science fiction novel that tells the story of two inventors who reprogram seashell robots to toast, and Elmo dolls to drive cars. Sound too novel?

There's a hacker artist from Dublin called Benjamin Gualon, who has founded the movement of recyclism, and has been creating unique ways to hack old hardware and extract more functionality out of them.

His most interesting project is The RES: made a totally unique object of beauty and joy – a custom

can be repurposed. An artist from New Zealand has turned circuit boards into lamps.

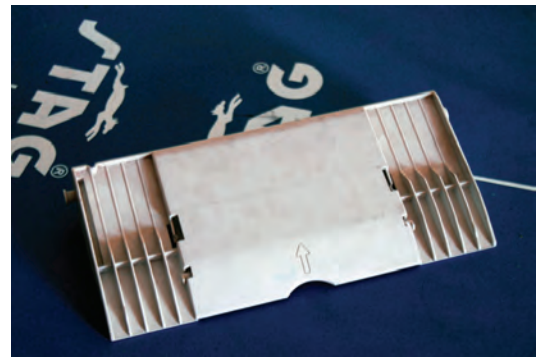
62 ways to use a dead computer, a book by Randy Sarafan, shows ways in which you can reuse and downcycle a computer's components. Notable ones include: A gamer guitar that's amped up using a computer's power supply, a keyboard lamp, earbud speakers, phone safe, gear

Open Design

Experts are contemplating the introduction of Open Source philosophies to Industrial Design as well, the movement is called Open Design



Garbage for good health?



A stripped down printer serves well as a laptop stand



Add a couple of fans and you have a cooler ready

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rock band kit out of 8-bit Nintendo consoles and a bunch of gamepads. Each gamepad handles one particular sound: bass, drums, synthesizer, percussions, etc. Surely our country of out-of-work electronics engineers can make things like these for cheap!

Older computers can be refurbished to boot on Linux, or they

clock, PDA doodler, Scanner table, and the Portable Amplifier made out of a desktop PC.

It's a really neat book, and it just scratches the surface! If you want more ideas, there's www.instructables.com as well!

Open Source Design

Afghanistan is a war-torn country, with no telecom regulatory authority or much of a telecom industry in the first place, it was the perfect testing ground for Volunteers from the MIT Bits and Atoms lab.

They built a wireless network in Jalalabad, Afghanistan out of locally sourced junk – pieces of board, wire, a plastic tub, and oil cans.

This is an open source open design initiative, which means that anyone can copy this design to build their own wireless network. The wiki also provides reflector designs, configuration files and instructions that anyone can use to turn a Linksys wrt54GLs router into a Fab-Fi.

According to the Fab-Fi wiki, the nodes use Linksys WRT54GL wireless routers running OpenWRT 8.09.1 (Kamikaze) firmware. Signboard

and acrylic, chicken wire, stainless woven mesh and window screen have been used as reflective materials.

These ghetto reflectors boost the range of the wireless network to a range of one kilometre. The locals are using the infrastructure for video Skype, and Google searches.

"I believe that distributed ownership without any legal payback obligations may spawn a richer way of looking at work, and of knowledge dissemination." says Poonam Bin Kasturi, founder of DailyDump.org.

The site sells affordable a kitchen waste composters which can convert



You'll find some really powerful magnets in your hard drive